PASO ROBLES JOINT UNIFIED SCHOOL DISTRICT
FULL TEXT OF MEASURE G-26

BOND MEASURE

With funds that cannot be taken by the State and spent elsewhere, shall Paso Robles Joint Unified School District's measure to renovate and expand classrooms and career training facilities; and repair leaky roofs and inefficient heating and air-conditioning be adopted authorizing $205 million of bonds with legal rates, average levies below $50 per $100,000 of assessed value (raising $12.2 million annually) while outstanding, audits, taxpayer oversight, no funds for administrator salaries, pensions or benefits, and full disclosure of all spending?

INTRODUCTION

The Paso Robles Joint Unified School District provides educational services to the residents of an area comprising approximately 800 square miles in San Luis Obispo County and Monterey County, California. The District was unified in 1997 with the joining of the Paso Robles Elementary School District and the Paso Robles High School District. The District operates 6 elementary schools, 2 middle schools, 1 high school, 1 continuation high school, and an independent study center.

The District serves approximately 2,175 students in grades 9 through 12 across four high school programs, Paso Robles High School, Liberty Continuation High School, Independence High School, and the Independent Skills Program. The classrooms and facilities supporting these students are in urgent need of investment.

Paso Robles High School's buildings are aging. The classrooms and facilities at Paso Robles High School are in need of repairs, upgrades, and renovation, including fixing deteriorating roofs, plumbing, and electrical systems; modernization of outdated existing classrooms, restrooms, and school facilities; and enhancement of campus safety and security. Paso Robles High School is also in need of classrooms and facilities to support career and technical education in fields like healthcare, aerospace, education, and technology and help its students learn valuable job skills so that they can be college-ready and compete for good-paying jobs when they graduate.

The District's Liberty Continuation High School and Independence High School currently share facilities and share the strain of growing enrollment. Independence High School needs its own dedicated classrooms. The classrooms at Liberty Continuation High School currently used by Independence High School students can then be repurposed and upgraded to expand career and technical education opportunities for Liberty Continuation High School's students. The District's Independent Skills Program, which serves students with disabilities, is also growing and is in need of classrooms and facilities designed to meet its students' needs.

War Memorial Stadium has aged to the point where both its turf and its infrastructure require significant work. War Memorial Stadium requires renovations to meet current Americans with Disabilities Act standards.

Addressing these needed facilities issues requires that the District ask the voters to approve a general obligation bond measure.

Dedicated funding is required to meet these needs and provide updated classrooms, labs, and facilities needed to support high-quality instruction in math, science, engineering, and technology to District students.

INVESTMENT IN CAREER TECHNICAL EDUCATION FACILITIES

The District's strategic plan, as most recently updated in 2026, contains the District's strategic goals and strategies to achieve those goals, supported by action plans, milestones, and metrics. The District's promise is to provide a safe, supportive environment where every student feels valued and empowered to discover their strengths, build resilience, and develop the knowledge, character, and confidence to thrive in their future. The District's goals are to ensure academic excellence, to ensure safe, supportive school communities, to build inclusive, engaged school communities, to recruit, develop and retain high-quality staff, to ensure the District's long-term fiscal sustainability, and to provide safe, modern facilities.

To accomplish its mission and its vision, the District provides an enriching, high-quality education to its students, preparing them for college, careers and 21st century jobs. The District also provides career and technical education programs to its students, including healthcare, aerospace, education, and technology skills training so that its students who choose not to go to college have the opportunity to learn valuable job skills and can compete for good-paying jobs when they graduate.

While the District's goal is to maintain and improve its facilities so that each student may learn in safe and healthy classrooms, the District has an ongoing need for basic repairs including fixing deteriorating classrooms, aging bathrooms and water pipes, plumbing, and electrical wiring; removing asbestos, lead paint and mold; ensuring safe, clean drinking water; maintaining fire safety; and replacing outdated security systems. Many of Paso Robles High School's buildings are in need of upgrades and repairs. Excellent schools and classrooms benefit the District's ability to recruit and retain excellent teachers. Addressing these needed facilities issues requires that the District ask its voters to approve a general obligation bond measure.

Asking the District's voters to approve a general obligation bond is a necessary step to securing both local and state funding. The State of California requires a local match, funded primarily through local general obligation bonds, for school districts wishing to pursue matching state funds for the upgrade or replacement of school buildings and facilities. The millions of dollars potentially available through the State match allows local taxpayers to benefit from the tax dollars they already pay to Sacramento.

It is imperative that our students can learn in safe, complete, comprehensive, and efficient facilities. We need to act locally to provide a school environment to ensure our students have the educational opportunities they deserve, and a school environment the community can take pride in.

The District will appoint a Citizens' Oversight Committee consisting of members of the community to ensure funds are only spent on voter-approved projects to improve the Paso Robles Joint Unified School District and not for any other purpose.

SCHOOL FACILITIES PROJECTS TO BE FUNDED FROM BOND PROCEEDS

As required by the California Constitution, the proceeds from the sale of the bonds will be used only for the purposes authorized under Article XIIIA of the California Constitution, including construction, reconstruction, rehabilitation, or replacement of school facilities, furnishing and equipping of school facilities, or the acquisition or lease of real property for school facilities, as specifically set forth in this ballot measure, and costs incident thereto, and not for any other purpose, including salaries and other routine school operating expenses.

The following project list describes the specific projects the District proposes to finance with proceeds of the bonds. The scope of specific projects, the order of construction, and their

completion are contingent on facilities planning, final project costs, and the availability of needed funds. Further, projects on the project list are of the type that issuing the authorized general obligation bonds will not cause the State to reduce any financial contribution that would otherwise be available to the District had these bonds not been authorized, issued, and/or expended for their stated purpose.

The project list includes both projects that can be completed using the bond proceeds, along with State matching funds and other building funds the District may receive and projects that are planned and needed but whose construction is contingent on the amount of bond funds available, plus the amount of State matching and other building funds the District may receive in the future, which is a function of the State building program rules, passage of State bonds, and the growth rate of the District. The completion of specific projects is also contingent on final project costs.

Projects on the Bond Project List are of the type that issuing the authorized general obligation bonds will not cause the State to reduce any financial contribution that would otherwise be available to the District had these bonds not been authorized, issued, and/or expended for their stated purpose.

Projects listed below may be completed at any and all high schools, sites and facilities (including support facilities) and other District-owned properties, where such project is determined necessary, including without limitation:

- Paso Robles High School
- Liberty Continuation High School
- Independence High School
- War Memorial Stadium
- The Independent Skills Program

The bond measure will fund improvements to the District's classrooms and facilities for the benefit of the District's students in grades 9 through 12, including the following:

- The construction, renovation, or expansion of career technical education/vocational education facilities to align to industry needs and local community demand
- The construction, renovation, or expansion of Science, Technology, Engineering, Arts, Math facilities and classrooms and labs
- The repair or replacement of leaking roofs, deteriorating plumbing, sewer and gas lines, storm drains and valves, electrical systems, and heating, ventilation and air conditioning systems, where needed
- The construction of new classrooms and classroom buildings
- The renovation, expansion and repair of existing classrooms and school facilities
- The acquisition and installation of updated safety systems, security cameras, fire alarm systems and other emergency communication systems
- Improvements to fencing, gates, pedestrian access, walkways, lighting, wayfinding, entrances, and drop-off/pickup locations
- The renovation, expansion, modernization and equipping of classrooms and facilities for music, band and performing arts
- Upgrades to electrical systems, data backup systems, Wi-Fi, network connections and infrastructure and other equipment to support demands of modern technology

- Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA) accessibility upgrades, including improvements to site access, walkways, parking, staff and student restrooms, and classrooms

Specific projects and District facilities to be improved include:

Paso Robles High School

- Construct career technical education/vocational education classrooms that are adaptable to industry demand
- Renovate existing classrooms
- Build a new cafeteria and related food service facilities
- Replace or refurbish restrooms, locker rooms, and other physical education and athletic facilities
- Improve athletic field including installing synthetic turf
- Remove antiquated buildings
- Construct a new gymnasium and related facilities
- Renovate and expand the existing library
- Improve parking areas, sidewalks and walkways
- Build classroom building with specialized learning spaces for students with disabilities and other student support facilities

Liberty Continuation and Independence High Schools

- Construct career technical education/vocational education classrooms that are adaptable to industry demand
- Build new classrooms for Liberty Continuation High School
- Renovate and improve restroom facilities with accessible restrooms

War Memorial Stadium and Independent Skills Program

- Increase and improve parking with accessible pathways
- Construct new shaded outdoor learning area
- Renovate or replace bleachers and add accessible seating
- Improve athletic field including installing synthetic turf
- Construct a new stadium drop-off/pickup area
- Refurbish and improve restroom facilities with accessible restrooms
- Construct new team training facilities
- Build new concession serving areas

Each of the bond projects described in the Project List includes the costs of furnishing and equipping such facilities, and all costs that are incidental but directly related to the types of projects described above.

To the extent permitted by law examples of incidental costs include, but are not limited to: costs of design, engineering, architect and other professional services, facilities assessments, inspections, site preparation, utilities, landscaping, construction management and other planning and permitting, legal, accounting and similar costs; independent annual financial and performance audits; a customary construction contingency; demolition and disposal of existing structures; the costs of interim housing and storage during construction including relocation and

construction costs incurred relating to interim facilities; rental or construction of storage facilities and other space on an interim basis for materials and other equipment and furnishings displaced during construction; costs of relocating facilities and equipment as needed in connection with the projects; interim classrooms and facilities for students, administrators, and school functions, including modular facilities; federal and state-mandated safety upgrades; addressing unforeseen conditions revealed by construction/modernization and other necessary improvements required to comply with existing building codes, including the Field Act; access requirements of the Americans with Disabilities Act; costs of the election; project construction oversight, management and administration during the duration of such projects, including by District personnel, and bond issuance costs.

In addition to the projects listed above, the repair and renovation of each of the existing school facilities may include, but not be limited to, some or all of the following: upgrade or install signage and clocks; repair and replace worn-out and deteriorated windows, walls, doors, interior and exterior finishes; replace or install drinking fountains; update sites and facilities for compliance with the Americans with Disabilities Act and current building codes; resurface or replace hard courts; repair or replace irrigation and drainage systems and campus landscaping; replace asphalt, concrete and broken pavement; interior and exterior painting, floor covering and tile replacement; repair, upgrade and install interior and exterior lighting systems.

Unforeseen conditions may arise during the course of planning, design and construction resulting in the scope and nature of any of the specific projects described above being altered by the District. In the event that the District determines that, with respect to a modernization or renovation project, it is more economical for the District or otherwise in the District's best interests to be undertaken as new construction, this bond measure authorizes said new construction, including land acquisition, relocation, expansion and construction and/or reconstruction, and all costs relating thereto. Conversely, if the District determines that it is more economical or otherwise in the best interests of the District to modernize or renovate District facilities instead of undertaking a new construction project, this bond measure authorizes such a project. In addition, this measure authorizes the acquisition of real property, including necessary rights of way or other real property interests, required to expand District facilities, to provide access to school or other District facilities, or to provide additional school or related facilities. Further, authorized projects include reimbursements for project costs previously paid and paying and/or prepaying interim financing for the types of projects included on the project list, such as bond anticipation notes. Finally, projects on this list may be undertaken and used as joint-use projects with other public agencies.

Approval of the District's bond measure does not guarantee that all of the identified projects within this Bond Project List will be funded. The District plans to continue to pursue funds from the State of California, if available, to complete certain of the identified facilities projects. The District is unable to anticipate all unforeseen circumstances which may prevent some of the projects listed above from being undertaken or completed.

The order in which projects are listed in the foregoing Bond Project List does not suggest an order of priority. Project prioritization is vested in and will be determined by the District Board of Trustees. Bond proceeds shall only be expended for the specific purposes identified herein. The District shall create an account into which proceeds of the bonds shall be deposited and comply with the reporting requirements of Government Code section 53410.

These projects may include participation in the State Facility Program's Joint-Use Program to gain matching funds for teacher education, multi-purpose rooms, gymnasiums, libraries, childcare, and other qualifying Joint-Use facilities. With respect to such joint-use projects, the

bond funds authorized by this Measure may be used to pay all of the local share needed to qualify the projects for special State matching funds under the State Facility Program's Joint-Use Program requirements.

The Board of Trustees hereby certifies that it has evaluated the safety, class-size reduction, and information technology needs of the District in developing this list of school facilities projects.

FISCAL ACCOUNTABILITY MEASURES

If the bonds are approved, the Board of Trustees will implement the following accountability measures:

(a) Use the bond proceeds only for the purposes authorized under Article XIIIA of the California Constitution, including construction, reconstruction, rehabilitation, or replacement of school facilities, furnishing and equipping of school facilities, or the acquisition or lease of real property for school facilities and related uses, as specifically set forth in this, Measure, and costs incident thereto, and not for any other purpose, including salaries and other routine school operating expenses;

(b) Conduct an annual, independent performance audit to ensure that the bond proceeds have been expended only on the projects and uses listed in this Measure;

(c) Conduct an annual, independent financial audit of the proceeds from the sale of the bonds until all of those proceeds have been expended for school facilities projects and uses listed in this Measure; and

(d) Establish and appoint members to an independent citizens' oversight committee to ensure the bonds are used only for the projects and uses listed in this Measure.

STATE MATCHING FUNDS

California Education Code section 15122.5 requires the following statement to be included in this sample ballot:

> "Approval of this bond measure does not guarantee that the proposed projects in the Paso Robles Joint Unified School District that are the subject of bonds under this measure will be funded beyond the local revenues generated by this bond measure. The school district's proposal for certain of the projects assumes the receipt of matching state funds, which are subject to appropriation by the Legislature or approval of a statewide bond measure."

ANNUAL TAX AMOUNT, RATE, AND DURATION

The bonds shall bear interest at an annual rate not exceeding the statutory maximum. The maturity of the bonds shall not exceed the maximum term allowed by law at the time of issuance (currently 25 years if issued under Education Code section 15140, or 40 years if issued under Government Code section 53508, so long as the bonds are not capital appreciation bonds ("CABs," which CABs are limited to 25 years)). Accordingly, as further set forth in the tax rate statement, the *ad valorem* tax will be levied at such rates and for so long as may be required to meet the debt service needs of the bonds proposed to be issued, including such bonds that may be issued to refund any approved bonds.

IMPARTIAL ANALYSIS OF MEASURE G-26

Bonds are financial instruments used to borrow money. Under the California Constitution, school districts may issue bonds if approved by at least 55 percent of voters within the boundaries of the district who are voting on a measure to authorize the issuance of bonds. Voter-approved bond financing is a common financing method in California for funding new school construction and other improvements to school facilities. Bonds are sold to the public and constitute a debt of the district. The principal and interest on the bonds are repaid by an annual property tax levy on all taxable real property within the jurisdiction of the school district, calculated on the current assessed value of each property (an "*ad valorem"* tax).

The Board of Trustees of the Paso Robles Joint Unified School District ("the District") has placed Measure G-26 on the ballot, proposing the sale of bonds in an amount not to exceed $205 million at interest rates not to exceed legal limits. The District's Tax Rate Statement, included in the voter information guide, which was mailed to voters of the District, reflects an estimate of the maximum property tax levies required to service the bonds.

In accordance with California Constitution, Article XIIIA, proceeds from the sale of the bonds may only be used for the construction, reconstruction, rehabilitation, replacement, furnishing and equipping of school facilities or the acquisition or lease of real property for school facilities. (The specific improvement projects are described in the full text of the measure.) The law prohibits the use of bond proceeds to pay for teacher and administrator salaries or other operational expenses.

Approval of the measure does not guarantee that all proposed projects to be improved with bond proceeds will be funded beyond the local revenues generated by the measure. The District's proposal for the projects assumes the receipt of matching state funds, which could be subject to appropriation by the Legislature or approval of a statewide bond measure.

As required by law, the District must follow certain accountability provisions to oversee the funds collected and expended, including the establishment of an independent citizens' oversight committee, the annual completion of performance and financial audits, and issuance of an annual report detailing the proceeds received by the sale of the bonds and the expenditures made. All of these requirements are reflected in the full text of measure.

The District's Tax Rate Statement provides the District's best estimate of the average annual tax rate that will be required to fund the bond issue over the duration of the debt service is $49.59 per $100,000 of assessed valuation while the bonds are outstanding. The final fiscal year in which the tax is anticipated to be collected is 2057-58.

A "yes" vote on this measure is a vote in favor of the issuance of $205 million in general obligation bonds to be used for the purposes set forth in Measure G-26.

A "no" vote on this measure is a vote against the issuance of $205 million in general obligation bonds for the purposes set forth in Measure G-26.

s/ JON ANSOLABEHERE
County Counsel

TAX RATE STATEMENT FOR MEASURE G-26

An election will be held in Paso Robles Joint Unified School District (the "District") on November 3, 2026, for the purpose of submitting to the electors of the District the question of incurring bonded indebtedness of the District in the maximum principal amount of $205,000,000. If such bonds are authorized and sold, the principal thereof and interest thereon will be payable from the proceeds of taxes levied on taxable property in the District. The following information regarding tax rates is given in compliance with Section 9401 of the California Elections Code. This information is based upon the best estimates and projections presently available from official sources, upon experience within the District and other demonstrable factors.

Based upon the foregoing and projections of the assessed valuations of taxable property in the District, and assuming the entire debt service on the bonds will be paid through property taxation:

1. The best estimate of the average annual tax rate that would be required to be levied to fund the bond issue over the entire duration of the bond debt service, based on assessed valuations available at the time of the filing of this statement, or a projection based on experience within the same jurisdiction or other demonstrable factors is $49.59 per $100,000 of assessed valuation of all property to be taxed. It is estimated that the final fiscal year in which the tax is anticipated to be collected is 2057-58.

2. The best estimate of the highest tax rate that would be required to be levied to fund the bond issue, and an estimate of the year in which that rate will apply, based on estimated assessed valuations available at the time of the filing of this statement, or a projection based on experience within the same jurisdiction or other demonstrable factors, is $54.90 per $100,000 of assessed valuation of all property to be taxed in the years 2027-28 to 2051-52.

3. The best estimate of the total debt service, including the principal and interest, that would be required to be repaid if all the bonds are issued and sold is approximately $377,831,054.

Attention of voters is directed to the fact that the foregoing information is based upon projections and estimates only. The actual timing of sales of the bonds and the amount to be sold at any time will be governed by the needs of the District and other factors. The actual interest rates at which the bonds will be sold, which will not exceed the maximum permitted by law, will depend upon the bond market at the time of sale. The actual assessed valuations in future years will depend upon the value of property within the District as determined in the assessment and the equalization process. Therefore, the actual tax rates and the years in which those tax rates will be applicable may vary from those presently estimated and stated above.

Voters should note that estimated tax rates are based on the *ASSESSED VALUE* of taxable property on the official tax rolls, *not* on the property's market value. Property owners should consult their own property tax bills to determine their property's assessed value and any applicable tax exemptions.

s/ Jennifer Loftus
Superintendent, Paso Robles Joint Unified School District

ARGUMENT IN FAVOR OF MEASURE G-26

Keep Our Tax Dollars Local / Protect Paso Robles Schools

Our local public schools are this community's most valuable asset. They educate our children. They protect our home values. They keep our local economy strong.

That's why we must now come together and support Measure G-26.

Measure G-26 protects taxpayers.

- **No Money for Sacramento**. Measure G-26 funds cannot be taken by Sacramento and spent elsewhere. It's the law. Your local tax dollars must and will be spent locally.
- **Legally Required Oversight**. Mandatory third-party annual audits. Public disclosure of all spending.
- **Funds for Schools—Not Administrators**. No administrator salaries. No administrator pensions. No administrator benefits. Measure G-26 guarantees that dollars will be used solely for the improvement of our schools. Period.

Measure G-26 will improve the lives of our children.

- **Career Training**. Updating and expanding Career Technical Education classrooms and facilities to prepare students for college, careers and skilled trades.
- **Classroom Renovations**. Renovating or replacing outdated or deteriorating classrooms.
- **Critical Infrastructure**. Repairing and replacing leaky roofs, deteriorated plumbing, aging electrical, and inefficient heating, ventilation and air-conditioning systems.

Measure G-26 will protect the value of our homes and our local businesses.

It will ensure safe schools for our children. It will require independent audits and **full disclosure of all spending**.

Most important of all—it will legally require that every tax dollar be spent in Paso Robles—**not shipped off to Sacramento**.

Let's Keep Paso Robles Strong!

Stand up and support our local public schools!

VOTE YES ON MEASURE G-26!

s/ Isiah Gomer
Local Business Owner, Assistant Football Coach

s/ Brett Butterfield
Owner - Ravine Waterpark, Former PR Roblan of the Year

s/ Dee Lacey
Former Trustee & Local Rancher

s/ Mark Perry
Roblan of the Year

S/ Sarah Kramer
Cattlewoman of the Year and Chairman of the Paso Robles Pioneer Day Committee

ARGUMENT AGAINST MEASURE G-26

Voters should reject the proposed PRJUSD G-26 bond measure.

The district's priority must be improving academic performance, not saddling taxpayers with another massive debt burden atop the troubled 2016 Measure M. PRJUSD's CAASPP scores continue to lag below state averages. Board focus and resources should target instruction, curriculum, and student achievement—not another facilities bond whose necessity and management are questionable.

Measure M authorized $95 million (with lifetime repayment exceeding $163 million). Nearly a decade later, serious facility shortfalls remain. This track record reflects poor execution, weak oversight, and unfulfilled promises. Taxpayers should not trust a new $180–205 million bond (lifetime cost ~$350–400 million) will fare better.

Compounding the mismanagement, the Measure M Citizens' Oversight Committee (COC) has not met in almost two years, even as bond projects continue and unspent funds remain. This directly violates Proposition 39 requirements for active, independent oversight of bond spending. When the very mechanism designed to protect taxpayers is dormant, accountability disappears.

The G-26 campaign further erodes trust through deceptive assertions of lead paint and mold at the high school. These claims contradict internal staff assessments, SARC/FIT reports, and the district's own facility evaluations—tactics seemingly intended to manufacture urgency rather than reflect reality.

Finally, the measure offers no binding commitment to specific, measurable projects. Without an enforceable project list and strict guardrails, funds can be redirected at the board's discretion—the same pattern that left Measure M deliverables incomplete.

PRJUSD students deserve a district that prioritizes measurable academic gains over blank-check facilities spending. Reject G-26 until the Paso Robles School Board demonstrates responsible stewardship of existing resources, accurate facility reporting, revived Prop-39 compliance, and a genuine plan to raise student achievement.

s/ Dorian K. Baker

s/ Tom Apkarian

s/ Randall Jordan

s/ J. Christopher Bausch
Private Citizen

s/ Faith Frankel

REBUTTAL TO THE ARGUMENT AGAINST MEASURE G-26

Measure G-26 invests in our children's future with real taxpayer protections.

Opponents cry "mismanagement," yet cannot name a single misspent dollar. That's because claims that the district's bond spending has gone unchecked are simply untrue.

In 2016, this community trusted the district to modernize our elementary schools—and it delivered. Every dollar spent was independently audited and fully disclosed as **required by State law**.

Members of the Citizens' Bond Oversight Committee—neighbors like you—have donated their time to review how bond funds are spent. Although filling committee vacancies has been challenging, the District has continually sought new members. (Proof that it's easier to criticize than to serve—**not one of the five signers** of the opposing argument has **ever** volunteered to be on this committee.)

Measure G-26 will improve aging and deteriorating classrooms at our local high schools. It will modernize Career Technical Education Centers that prepare students for well-paying skilled trades, college, and local careers, while repairing leaky roofs, deteriorating plumbing, failing electrical systems, and inefficient heating and cooling systems.

Measure G-26 protects taxpayers:

- Every dollar stays in Paso Robles and cannot be taken by the State and spent elsewhere. It's the law.
- Independent annual audits and full public disclosure of all spending are mandatory.
- Not one cent for administrator salaries, pensions, or benefits.

Strong schools protect our home values, strengthen our local economy, and expand opportunities for local students.

Keep our tax dollars local. Protect our schools.

Vote YES on Measure G-26.

s/ Isiah Gomer
Local Business Owner, Assistant Football Coach

s/ Brett Butterfield
Owner - Ravine Waterpark, Roblan of the Year

s/ Dee Lacey
Former Trustee & Local Rancher

s/ Mark Perry
Roblan of the Year

THERE WAS NO REBUTTAL TO THE ARGUMENT IN FAVOR OF MEASURE G-26 FILED